

# Cameroon

**Ratio:** 2:3 **Adopted:** May 20, 1975 **Usage:** National and Civil

The pattern of the flag reflects the French *Tricolore*



Red, yellow, and green are the pan-African colors

*The star of unity*

*Yellow symbolizes prosperity*

*Green represents hope*

*The red stripe represents unity*

Africa



**Cameroon** was originally a German colony, which was partitioned by the French and the British after World War I.

The French area became autonomous on January 1, 1959 and independent a year later. A national flag was adopted during the period of French control and was the first West African flag after that of Ghana to use the red, yellow, and green colors. The actual design is based on the French *Tricolore*. The original design of 1959 did not have a star.

## A NEW UNITED FLAG

In 1961, the southern part of British Cameroon joined the former French colony forming the current state of Cameroon. To mark this, two yellow stars were placed in the upper hoist. In 1975, the two stars were replaced by a

single star in the center of the flag to symbolize the new unity of the state.

## THE NATIONAL ARMS

The coat of arms, like the flag, has been altered to reflect the changes in the constitution. The date of independence of French Cameroon has been removed, leaving just the name of the state on the scroll and there is now only one yellow star in the green on the shield. The main features of the current arms are a map of the country, a balance, and two crossed fasces or local axes. The shield is divided in the colors of the national flag; green, red, and yellow.